

# STEREO BRICK AMPLIFIER

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If you are looking for a compact and inexpensive add-on audio amplifier for your digital surround sound system or computer, then stereo brick amplifier is suitable for your needs. It delivers 15W per channel in stereo mode and about 29W in bridge-mono mode from a box as small as a house brick.

Many low-cost DVD players available in the market do not have in-built audio amplifiers. To enjoy stereophonic

sound, you have to buy separate left and right speakers. Moreover, to play a DVD in Dolby Digital format, you would probably need five amplifiers and speakers, one for each of the channels.

Like many audio projects published earlier in EFY, stereo brick amplifier can upgrade the audio system according to your personal taste. It helps a low-cost DVD player to play excellent Dolby Digital (AC-3) surround sound.

Dolby Digital '5.1 channel' systems have separate channel outputs,



with the centre-front signal quite different from the front, left and right ones. Many DVDs have main screen dialogues on the centre-front track, so to hear dialogues, you need a centre-front amplifier and speaker. Besides, there are separate rear channel signals with Dolby Digital for MPEG and DTS encoding, and to hear them you need

two separate amplifiers and speakers. The subwoofer track (low frequency effect, LFE) is quite discrete in Dolby Digital encoding. It delivers most of the grunt for explosions. So, if you watch an action movie without a subwoofer, you miss out most of the sound effects.

In brief, in order to enjoy Dolby Digital format movies, one needs three extra speakers and matching amplifiers apart from stereo system. Getting extra speakers at affordable price

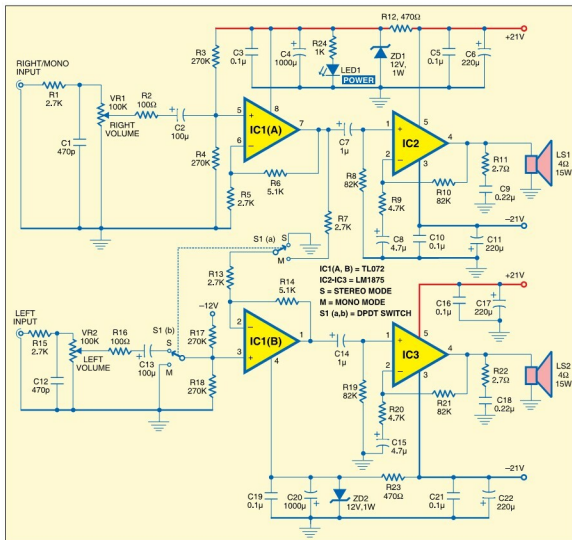


Fig. 1: Stereo brick amplifier circuit